# Decisions at Northwind: case file

MOS-240 Mosaic Signal practical · Teaching case: Northwind Health is fictional.

## The dataset: Exhibit S3

**This is a teaching case. Some Mosaic features appear in it earlier than they were released.** All names and figures are invented for teaching.

**Exhibit S3 · "Decisions at Northwind" · 11 January – 5 February 2027**
Frontline and supervisory staff in Nursing, the Clinic Network and Support Services. Huddles, QR posters and one email with the anonymous link. **204 stories** (cap 250). Average 71 words.

**The questions:** next page, "Exhibit S4-final: the questions".

**Context (counts are stories):** Hospital 118 · A clinic 78 · Both 8 | Frontline 152 · Charge nurse, team lead or supervisor 41 · Manager or above 11 | Joined before the merger at Northwind 97 · at Lakeside 52 · after the merger 55.

**Triad: what shaped the decision most?**

| | People doing the work | Data and evidence | The deadline |
|---|---|---|---|
| All (204) | 17% | 38% | 45% |
| Hospital (118) | 14% | 44% | 42% |
| Clinic (78) | 21% | 29% | 50% |

Dots: a dense band along the bottom edge; a cluster of about 30 stories in the deadline corner; the people corner nearly empty (14 of 204 stories with People ≥ 50%, too few to split by site).

**Dyad: when did you hear about this decision?** (0 before it was made ↔ 100 after it was in place)
Mean 71 · Median 80 · Std Dev 27. 124 stories at 75–100; 29 at 0–25; 51 between. Mean by role: frontline 80; supervisors 48 (two humps); managers 30 (11 stories).

**Dyad: afterwards, what did people mostly do?** (0 worked around it ↔ 100 made it work as intended)
Mean 50 · Median 49 · Std Dev 31. 73 stories at 0–20; 67 at 80–100; 64 between. Filtered by when they heard: heard after (75–100) mean 41; heard before (0–25) mean 72; in between mean 59.

**Stones** (Absent → Fully present; Hindered → Helped; 0–1 scales)

| Stone | Placements | Present | Helped | Individual view |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Why it was decided | 188 | 0.31 | 0.38 | Mostly absent, toward hindered |
| A chance to give input | 171 | 0.24 | 0.47 | Split: most absent; a group of 38 present but hindered |
| The information I needed | 196 | 0.55 | 0.52 | Spread everywhere |
| My manager | 159 | 0.66 | 0.68 | Present and helped, similar by site |

Density view hottest: far-left middle.

**Narrative explorer:** 204 stories. Top words: schedule, staff, told, email, change, patients, unit, huddle. "huddle": 41 stories.

**Ten stories with their placements:** the page after next, "Exhibit S3.8: ten stories with their placements" (S3-01 to S3-10).

## Exhibit S4-final: the questions

**Exhibit S4-final** (Morgan Ellis, Dec 2026): the framework fielded as S3. *Teaching case: fictional data.*

- **Intro text:** "This takes about five minutes. Share one real story about a decision that affected your work. It can be good, bad or mixed. Your answers are anonymous: we don't collect your name or email. Please write about what happened rather than who was involved. A small team at Northwind and the Mosaic team will read every story. We may share short, edited extracts that don't identify anyone. Taking part is voluntary."
- **Distribution:** link and QR posters at huddles, and an email from Alex Moreau with the same anonymous link. Anonymous Responses on.
- **Story question:** text "Tell us about a decision that affected your work"; description "Big or small, made by anyone. There are no right or wrong stories."; prompt box: *"Think of a recent time, in the last three months, when a decision affected your work. What happened?"* Min 20, max 400 words, word count shown.
- **Triad T1:** "In this story, what shaped the decision most?" Corners (top) **The people doing the work**, (bottom-left) **Data and evidence**, (bottom-right) **The deadline**.
- **Dyad D1:** "When did you hear about this decision?" **Before it was made (0) ↔ After it was in place (100)**.
- **Dyad D2:** "Afterwards, what did people mostly do?" **Worked around it (0) ↔ Made it work as intended (100)**.
- **Stones S:** "How did each of these show up in your story? Leave out any that weren't part of it." Items: **Why it was decided**, **A chance to give input**, **The information I needed**, **My manager**. x: **Absent → Fully present**; y: **Hindered → Helped**.
- **Context (optional):** "Where do you mostly work?" Hospital / A clinic / Both. "Your role" Frontline staff / Charge nurse, team lead or supervisor / Manager or above. "When did you join Northwind?" Before the merger, at Northwind / Before the merger, at Lakeside Clinic Group / After the merger.

## Exhibit S3.8: ten stories with their placements

Paraphrased; identifying details removed. *Teaching case: fictional data.*

| # | Context | Story | Placements |
|---|---|---|---|
| S3-01 | Hospital · Frontline · Before merger, Northwind | "The new admission paperwork came out in a Friday email and was live Monday. Half of us found out at handover." | Deadline 70% · D1 92 · D2 18 · Why: absent, hindered |
| S3-02 | Clinic · Frontline · Lakeside | "They changed the lab courier. Nobody asked the front desk, and pick-ups now miss our last draw. We hold samples in the fridge and call the hospital ourselves." | Deadline 55%, Data 20% · D1 95 · D2 8 · Input: absent |
| S3-03 | Hospital · Supervisor · Before merger, Northwind | "We were asked for feedback on the new break rota in a survey. Then the rota came out exactly as first proposed." | Data 50%, Deadline 40% · D1 30 · D2 40 · Input: present (0.8), hindered (0.2) |
| S3-04 | Clinic · Supervisor · Lakeside | "Our manager brought the float-pool rota to the huddle. We tried two versions for two weeks each, then picked one together. It's the first change since the merger that stuck." | People 78% · D1 8 · D2 90 · Input: present, helped |
| S3-05 | Hospital · Frontline · After merger | "Moving the IV pumps to the new store made sense on paper: fewer trips for pharmacy. Nobody timed the walk from our ward." | Data 62% · D1 88 · D2 35 · Information: present, hindered |
| S3-06 | Hospital · Frontline · Before merger, Northwind | "Cleaning schedules moved to the shared system. The data says it's faster. It is, for the supervisor." | Data 58% · D1 90 · D2 22 |
| S3-07 | Hospital · Frontline · After merger | "Honestly a good decision: closing the overflow unit at night. We'd been asking for it for a year. We found out from the rota." | Data 40%, Deadline 35% · D1 96 · D2 85 · Why: absent |
| S3-08 | Clinic · Manager or above · After merger | "I was told about a change to our opening hours shortly before patients were. I had to tell my team, and I didn't know why either." | Deadline 80% · D1 97 · D2 45 · Why: absent, hindered |
| S3-09 | Hospital · Frontline · Before merger, Northwind | "Agency shifts were cut at short notice because of the budget. We understood why: the numbers were shared at the town hall. Still hard." | Data 45%, Deadline 45% · D1 70 · D2 60 · Why: present, helped |
| S3-10 | Hospital · Supervisor · Before merger, Northwind | "Our unit council chose the new handover format under the decision-rights pilot. It took longer, but everyone uses it." | People 60% · D1 15 · D2 88 · Input: present, helped |